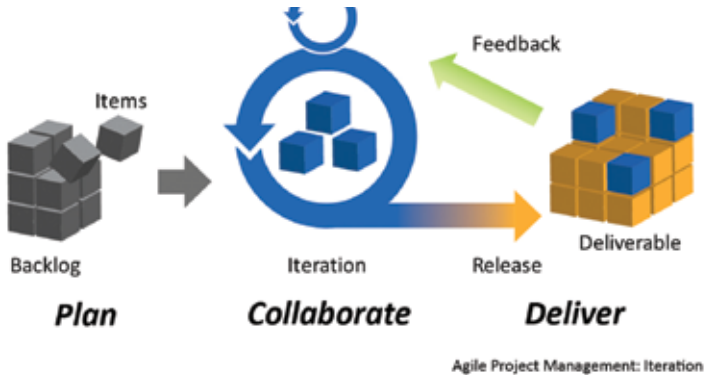


was chaos in the software development methodology space (and even a methodology called the chaos model), and they wanted to find the most efficient way to clean up the mess by incorporating the best of the methods such as Extreme Programming and Scrum Development, among others. It was meant to be faster and incorporate change better than even Iterative or Rapid Application Development. This resulted in the publication of the Manifesto for Agile Software Development.



The Process of Being Agile

Agile Methods are very similar to Lean Methods, which originated in the Manufacturing Industry (1950s, Toyota). They focus on breaking down the software solution into its individual components or features. These individual features are concurrently developed over many iterations (called sprints) by cross-functional teams who are given free reign. In this methodology, the clients are highly involved in the development, and the teams also need to meet frequently in order to incorporate feedback. There are mainly 12 principles of Agile Software Development Manifesto :

1. Customer satisfaction by early and continuous delivery of useful software
2. Welcome changing requirements, even late in development
3. Working software is delivered frequently (weeks rather than months)
4. Close, daily cooperation between business people and developers
5. Projects are built around motivated individuals, who should be trusted
6. Face-to-face conversation is the best form of communication (co-location)
7. Working software is the principal measure of progress
8. Sustainable development, able to maintain a constant pace